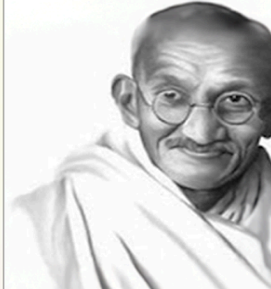


General Knowledge

Modern History

STUDY NOTES

The Advent of Europeans in India



The Advent of Europeans



- The 15th century AD was majorly a European Renaissance period.
- Between the 15th to 17th centuries, many sea voyages took place and discovered many new places.
- This period is called as '**The Age of Discoveries**'.
- Europeans started making colonies in the new areas. Their motive was very clear to trade the raw materials from these new areas to support the Industrial Revolution in Europe.
- In India, Portuguese, Dutch, English, Danes, and French companies became successful in making the colonies.

Why Europeans Wanted to Discover New Routes to India?

European explorers were eager to discover new routes to India during the 15th and 16th centuries for several key reasons:

- **Direct Access to Valuable Spices and Goods:**
 - India was a rich source of spices such as **pepper, cinnamon, and cloves**, which were highly prized in Europe for their use in food preservation and flavouring.
 - Accessing these goods directly promised immense profits.

- **Bypassing Middle Eastern Trade Monopolies:**

- Overland trade routes to India were controlled by **Middle Eastern powers like the Ottoman Empire**, which imposed heavy taxes and tolls.
- Finding a sea route allowed Europeans to bypass these intermediaries, reducing costs and increasing profits.

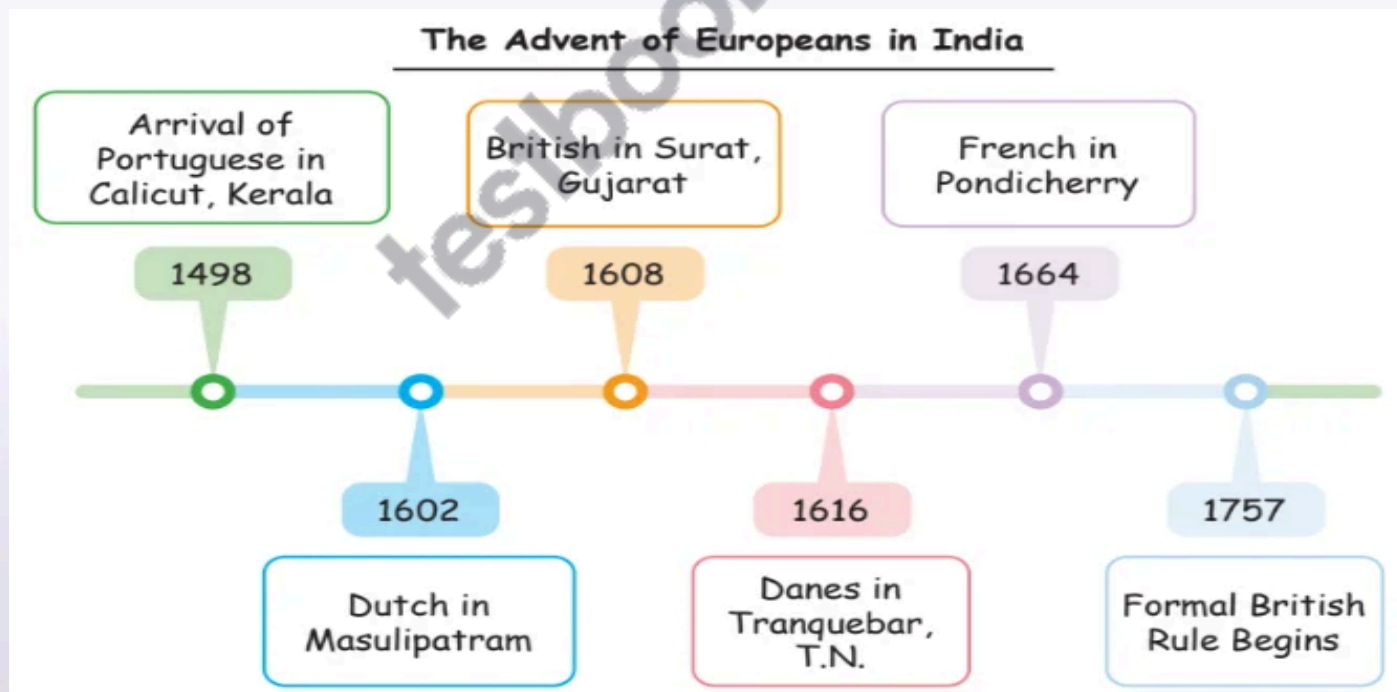
- **Economic and National Rivalries:**

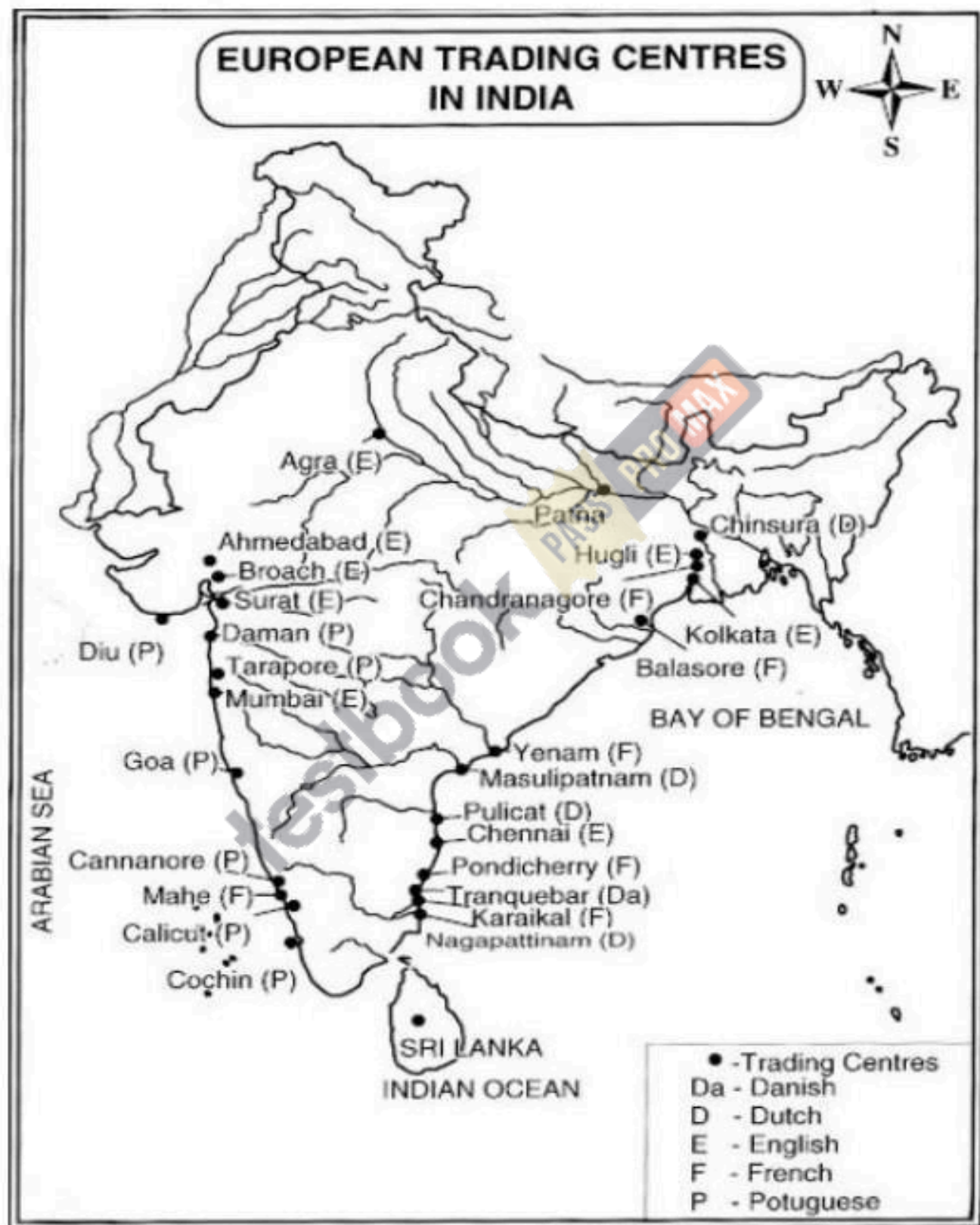
- European nations like **Portugal and Spain** were in fierce competition for global trade dominance.
- Establishing new routes to India would give them an economic advantage over their rivals by controlling the lucrative spice trade.

- **Desire for Exploration and Expansion:**

- Advances in navigation and shipbuilding fueled a spirit of exploration.
- Discovering new territories offered opportunities for expanding empires, spreading Christianity, and enhancing national prestige.

- **Timeline of Europeans**





European Power	First Center	Established	Ended
Portuguese	Cochin, Kerala	1503	1961
Dutch	Masulipatnam	1605	1759
British	Masulipatnam	1608	1947
Danish	Tranquebar	1620	1745
French	Surat	1668	1954

• Arrival of Portuguese in India

- **Vasco da Gama** arrived with three ships at Calicut in **1498 AD** welcomed by **Zamorin(ruler of Calicut)**.
- In 1503 AD, the **first Portuguese fort at Cochin** was established.
- It was the period which witnessed the **spice trade**.
- **Colonies of Portuguese:**
 - Calicut, Cochin, Goa, San Thome, Diu, Daman.

Decline:

- By the **end of the 17th century**, the **Portuguese in India lost their commercial influence**.
- Portuguese were completely **ousted by the Dutch** and one of all the ports on the Malabar coast in 1663 AD.
- Portuguese dominated Surat in the 16th century till 1530 AD. Later other trading groups like French, Armenians, English, Dutch and Turks were sharing the space until the first trading factory by the English was set up in 1612 AD.
- Their religious policy like **the activities of Jesuits and antagonism against Muslims and Hindus made Hindus and Muslims resentful against them**.

- Piracy at various places encouraged by the Portuguese antagonized Mughal rulers like Shajahan. This led to several wars against the Portuguese.

• Arrival of Dutch

- Dutch founded their first factory in **Masulipatnam in 1605 AD.**
- They became a **threat to the Portuguese** by establishing trade centres in India.
- **Nagapattinam near Madras was captured by the Portuguese.**
- Colonies of Dutches:
 - **Nagapattinam, Chinsurah, Baroda, Bimlipatam, Balasore, etc.**
- Dutch **interconnected the Indian territory** commercially.
- Eg. They **carried Indigo manufactured in the Yamuna Valley and Central India, Textiles and Silk from Bengal, Gujarat and the Coromandel, saltpetre from Bihar, and opium from the Ganga Valley.**
- They adopted a **Redistributive policy i.e. buying goods from one country and using them to purchase goods in another country.**



Decline

- The Dutch prioritized their interests in the **East Indies (modern Indonesia)** over India due to its lucrative spice trade, leading to limited resources and attention in India.
- The Dutch faced fierce competition from the British East India Company, which had stronger naval power and better alliances with Indian rulers, gradually pushing the Dutch out.
- The Dutch were decisively defeated by the British in key battles, such as the **Battle of Colachel (1741)** against the **Kingdom of Travancore**, which diminished their influence.
- Dutch-controlled ports in India, like **Pulicat and Nagapattinam**, were less strategically important compared to British-controlled ports like Bombay, leading to a decline in trade.
- During the Napoleonic Wars in Europe, the Dutch Republic was weakened and its colonies were vulnerable. The British took advantage and seized Dutch holdings in India.

- By the early 19th century, the **Dutch formally ceded their Indian colonies to the British**, marking the end of their presence in India

• Arrival of British

- The **English East India Company (EEIC)** was established in **1600** by a Royal Charter, granting it exclusive trading rights east of the Cape of Good Hope.
- **Captain William Hawkins** attempted to secure permission from **Jahangir** to open a factory in **Surat**, but the Portuguese initially thwarted his efforts.
- In 1611, the British navy aided the Mughals in defeating the Portuguese at Surat, gaining the right to establish a factory there, followed by factories in Masulipatam and other East Coast locations.
- **Sir Thomas Roe, sent to the Mughal court in 1615**, secured a Royal Farman allowing the British to establish factories and trade freely in the Mughal Empire, leading to factories at Broach, Ahmadabad, and a fortified Surat.
- In 1639, the British negotiated with local rulers to set up a factory in Madras, which was also fortified.
- Bombay was acquired as dowry in **1661-62 by King Charles II** and transferred to the English EIC in 1668, strengthening their presence in India.
- By **1680, the EIC received customs-free trading rights across Mughal territories**, and after the Carnatic Wars, the British emerged as the dominant power in India, transitioning from traders to rulers.



• Colonies of British:

- **Ft. William(Calcutta), Ft.St.George (Madras), Surat, Calcutta, Broach**
- The first time European imperialism was faced by India.
- For the first time, the whole Indian subcontinent was united politically under British rule.
- India was introduced to the Western style of rules and regulations.
- India was introduced to the new liberal ideas of the West for example rule of law.

There are so many Viceroys/Governor Generals:

- **Robert Clive, Warren Hastings, Cornwallis, Wellesley, Dalhousie, etc** were the Viceroy/Governor Generals who not only set up the **commercial base** but also converted it into a **political base**.

Decline:

- **Indian Independence Movement:**

- A strong and organized independence movement emerged, led by figures like Mahatma Gandhi and Jawaharlal Nehru, advocating for self-rule and mobilizing mass support through non-violent protests and civil disobedience.

- **World War II Impact:**

- The financial strain of World War II weakened Britain's economy, making it increasingly difficult to maintain control over its colonies. The war also heightened nationalist sentiments in India.

- **The Quit India Movement (1942):**

- This was a significant movement led by the Indian National Congress, demanding an end to British rule. It saw widespread protests and civil disobedience, demonstrating the Indian population's resolve to achieve independence.

- **International Pressure:**

- Post-war, there was growing international pressure against colonialism and for self-determination. The United Nations, formed in 1945, promoted decolonization, influencing British policy.

- **Partition and Independence (1947):**

- The increasing communal tensions and the demand for a separate Muslim state led to the partition of India. The traumatic events surrounding partition compelled the British to hasten their exit, resulting in India gaining independence on August 15, 1947.

• **Arrival of Danes**

- The **Danish East India Company** was established in **1616 AD**.
- In 1628 AD they founded the factory at Tranquebar near Tanjore.
- Their principal settlement was at Serampore near Calcutta.
- Danish factories were sold to the British in 1845 AD.
- **Colonies of Danes : Tranquebar near Tanjore.**
- **Danes are better known for their missionary activities** than for commerce.

● Arrival of French

- In **1673 AD**, Sher Khan Lodi the governor of Valikondapuram(in Bijapur) granted Francois Martin a land grant.
- Francois Martin set up a **factory at Pondicherry in 1674 AD**.



● Colonies of french:

- **Pondicherry, Mahe, Chandernagore, etc**
- For the first time, Indian people get recruited into the European army.
- Interference in internal political matters was started by the Europeans

● Rulers:

○ **Joseph Francis Dupleix**

- In **1741 AD**, Dupleix became the **Governor-General of Pondicherry**.
- He increased the commercial expansion of the French East India Company in India.
- Before this, he was given the responsibility of commercial expansion in **North America**.
- He had mastery in diplomacy. He made many diplomatic arrangements that proved beneficial for the French East India Company.
- Eg. He had a good relationship with the Nawab of Hyderabad and the Nawab of Carnatic.
- He was the **first ruler to interfere in the internal politics of the Indian rulers**.
- He formed the mixed regiment army which included Indian and French soldiers together.
- During his time, history witnessed **two Anglo-French wars**.



Decline

● **Limited Territorial Control:**

- The French established only a few small territories in India, primarily in

Puducherry (Pondicherry) and Chandannagar.

- This limited geographical reach made it difficult for them to compete with larger powers like the British.

- **Competition with the British:**

- The British East India Company emerged as the dominant colonial power in India, engaging in military conflicts with the French
- Key battles, such as the Battle of Plassey (1757) and the Battle of Wandiwash (1760), significantly weakened French positions.

- **Decline of the French East India Company:**

- The French East India Company faced financial difficulties and mismanagement, which hampered its ability to compete effectively against the British.
- The company struggled to maintain its trading posts and failed to secure significant profits.

- **Impact of the Seven Years' War (1756-1763):**

- The global conflict between Britain and France, known as the Seven Years' War, had profound effects on their colonial ambitions.
- The British victory in this war allowed them to expand their influence in India at the expense of the French.

- **Treaty of Paris (1763):**

- The Treaty of Paris concluded the Seven Years' War, resulting in France ceding many of its territories in India to the British.
- While France retained control of Puducherry, its influence was significantly reduced.

- **Post-Napoleonic Wars and Final Decline:**

- After the Napoleonic Wars, the French focus shifted to rebuilding their European territories.
- Their colonial ambitions in India were overshadowed by British expansion, and by the mid-19th century, French presence in India was largely limited to Puducherry, which was eventually integrated into India post-independence in 1954.